

Ten *Cool* Custom Android ROMs

In an earlier article (June 2012), I discussed the advantages of rooting your Android phones and flashing with custom ROMs. This article lists what I consider the top 10 custom Android ROMs for the Samsung Galaxy S3 and other devices.



With the current availability of advanced quad-core devices, and the immense customisation capabilities built in with Android ICS and Jelly Bean, the ROMing scene has shot up in popularity, with almost every enthusiast with just basic technical skills trying ROMs like CyanogenMod. It now seems plausible that in a few years, things might turn out to be like the Linux community, where innumerable distributions are available—the only limiting factor being the fact that ROMs are specific to the smartphone hardware that they are built for. Actually, this is all that prevents someone from building a website like Distrowatch for Android.

In order to get an insight into the Android community, we need to narrow down our search for ROMs of a specific device. Since the Samsung Galaxy S3 is one of the best and the most popular devices yet, let's look at what we can find to customise this smartphone. Many developers support more than one device, and you'll find that this will

be loosely relevant to your smartphone too. Custom ROMs for the Galaxy S3 are available in many broad categories. The most popular ones are:

- **Samsung-based ROMs:** These are the ROMs based on the official Samsung stock ROM. These types usually provide Touchwiz-specific features like the new Multiwindow, Motion, S Voice, etc. Though the major focus is to remove bloat and add tweaks, users have a choice between many different configurations in different ROMs.
- **AOSP ROMs:** These are based on the Android Open Source Project, i.e., they depend on the official Android sources and provide tweaks and customisations along with a 'vanilla Android experience', which most users crave.
- **MIUI ROMs:** These are based on a version of Android developed by the Chinese Xiaomi Corporation and are well known for their heavy UI customisation abilities and beautiful interfaces, along with robust theming support.
- **AOKP ROMs:** Technically, AOKP is an AOSP ROM